Celebrate

Fourth Sunday of Advent

December 21, 2025

First Church

Celebrate Service - January 4, 2026

GATHERING

Welcome & Lighting of the Candles

Pastor Duane Carlisle

Song

"Peace Has Come"

Call to Worship

L: In the dark of morning,
P: the stars still shine.
L: In the depth of winter,
P: the birds still climb.
L: At the start of the year,
tender and new,
P: God is here.
God is near.
L: Do not rest in your fear.
P: God is here.
L: So like the stars and the birds,
P: Let us worship holy God.

Gospel Lesson

Matthew 2:1-12, 16-18

After Jesus was born in Bethlehem in Judea, during the time of King Herod, Magi from the east came to Jerusalem and asked, “Where is the one who has been born king of the Jews? We saw his star when it rose and have come to worship him.”

When King Herod heard this he was disturbed, and all Jerusalem with him. When he had called together all the people’s chief priests and teachers of the law, he asked them where the Messiah was to be born. “In Bethlehem in Judea,” they replied, “for this is what the prophet has written:

“‘But you, Bethlehem, in the land of Judah,
are by no means least among the rulers of Judah;
for out of you will come a ruler
who will shepherd my people Israel.’”

Then Herod called the Magi secretly and found out from them the exact time the star had appeared. He sent them to Bethlehem and said, “Go and search carefully for the child. As soon as you find him, report to me, so that I too may go and worship him.”

After they had heard the king, they went on their way, and the star they had seen when it rose went ahead of them until it stopped over the place where the child was. When they saw the star, they were overjoyed. On coming to the house, they saw the child with his mother Mary, and they bowed down and worshiped him. Then they opened their treasures and presented him with gifts of gold, frankincense and myrrh. And having been warned in a dream not to go back to Herod, they returned to their country by another route.

When Herod realized that he had been outwitted by the Magi, he was furious, and he gave orders to kill all the boys in Bethlehem and its vicinity who were two years old and under, in accordance with the time he had learned from the Magi. Then what was said through the prophet Jeremiah was fulfilled:

“A voice is heard in Ramah,
weeping and great mourning,
Rachel weeping for her children
and refusing to be comforted,
because they are no more.”

L: The Word of God in scripture, for the Word of God among us, for the Word of God within us:

P: Thanks be to God.

Song
"Light Of The World"

Opening Prayer

God of the Stars,
like the magi,
we come to this place searching for you.
So today, just like every day,
we ask that you would remove any barricades that keep us from your Spirit.
Clear out the distractions.
Wipe away the doubt.
Open up our hearts,
and speak to us through these ancient words.

And as you do,
we will keep walking.
As you do,
we will move toward you.
With hope we pray,
amen.

PROCLAIMING

Message to Young Disciples

Message

Fear Doesn't Stop Us

RESPONDING

Pastoral Prayer

The Lord's Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

Invitation to Generosity

Passing of the Peace

SENDING FORTH

Song

"A Christmas Hymn (To The Tune Of "Come Thou Fount")"

Benediction

Postlude

Peace Has Come

by Ben Hastings, Seth Simmons, and Ben Fielding

Verse 1

Behold the star of Bethlehem
The Word of God has become flesh
Unto us a child is born
The Saviour of this broken world

Chorus 1

Oh hear the angel voices sing
Come let us adore Him
Peace has come
For our King is with us

Verse 2

Fully God and fully man
He comes for all with open hands
He rules with love on David's throne
All praise belongs to Christ alone

Chorus 2

Holy holy holy
Jesus we adore Thee
Peace has come
For our King is with us

Bridge 1

O come let us adore Him
O come let us adore Him
O come let us adore Him
Christ the Lord

Light Of The World

by Lauren Daigle, Paul Duncan, and Paul Mabury

Verse 1

The world waits for a miracle
The heart longs for a little bit of hope
O come O come Emmanuel
A child prays for peace on earth
And she's calling out from a sea of hurt
O come O come Emmanuel
And can you hear the angels singing

Chorus 1

Glory to the Light of the world
Glory the Light of the world is here

Verse 2

The drought breaks with the tears of a mother
A baby’s cry is the sound of love come down
Come down Emmanuel woh
He is the song for the suffering
He is Messiah the Prince of peace has come
He has come Emmanuel oh

Chorus 2

Glory to the light of the world
Glory to the light of the world
Glory to the light of the world
Glory to the light of the world

Bridge

For all who wait for all who hunger
For all who’ve prayed for all who wonder
Behold your King behold Messiah
Emmanuel Emmanuel

Chorus 3

Glory to the light of the world
Glory to the light of the world
Glory to the light of the world
Behold your King behold Messiah
Emmanuel Emmanuel

Ending

The world waits for a miracle
The heart longs for a little bit of hope
O come O come Emmanuel

A Christmas Hymn (To The Tune Of "Come Thou Fount")

by Chris Llewellyn and Savannah Locke

Verse 1

Come now see the Lord of Heaven in a lowly manger laid
King de - serving of a throne room born a poor powerless babe
Oh the mystery oh the wonder somehow God is one of us
Such is greatness in His kingdom He descended to our dust

Verse 2

Christ the Word holy ex - pression of the humble - ness of God
Herald of a prideless kingdom one of sacri - ficial love
Mighty One who made the heavens knelt to wash his brother's feet
And the earth that He cre - ated He be - stowed un - to the meek

Verse 3

King of glory became nothing humbled to the point of death
Stretched His arms out like a beggar and for - gave with His last breath
What God started with a manger ended with an empty grave
Suffering servant now ex - alted Jesus name a - bove all names

Verse 4

Light e - ternal in the darkness He shall not be over - come
Shining over all our shadows every curse has been un - done
Heaven breaks forth like the springtime through the winter of our souls
Now His life is life a - bundant is for - ever ours to know

Verse 5

Come now church let us adore Him tune your heart to sing His grace
Streams of mercy never ceasing call for songs of loudest praise
Teach me some mel - odious sonnet sung by flam - ing tongues a - bove
Praise the mount I'm fixed up - on it mount of God's re - deeming love
Praise the mount I'm fixed up - on it mount of God's re - deeming love

Prayers

Concerns Shared

Rene Reynoso, Cousin of Letty Mitchell
WR Miller
Marissa Rowe, Niece of Barbara Krause
Mace Williams
Emily Mclaughlin, Niece of Mary Maxine
All in need of prayers

Those In Memory Care

Jack Gaunt
Pat Staver

Our Military

CDR James Beaty
SMAN Kevin Clute
LTC Kevin Field
HM2 Kim Fountain
AWR1 Isaiah Hale
MSG Anthony Mauro
SMAN Ben Ridings
LCDR Alex Turco
TSGT Gerald Welker

Worship Team

Band

Acoustic Guitar:
Kory Pritchett

Bass Guitar:
Becca Pritchett

Drums:
Cade Quinn

Electric Guitar:
Nick Clinkenbeard

Keys:
Ryan Madden

Vocal:
Amanda Hedden
Karen Hull

Pastors

Lead Pastor:
Duane Carlisle

Assistant Pastor:
Kory Pritchett

Quick Links

Giving

Bulletin

Check In

To be put on the weekly announcement emails, contact Ronda at 765-743-1285 or rkroeschen@fumcwl.org
ght and licensing liturgy: Ministry Matters, www.umcdiscipleship.org, Music: CCLI 1218620; CCSWorshipCa